



JPEG to be 'Secure'

JPEG recently launched a privacy & security initiative to bring advanced security and copy protection to JPEG images <http://dg.it.in/Nv15v>



Your smartphone knows

Smartphones come with a number of sensors and a study says that it can guess when you are depressed. Read here. <http://dg.it.in/Nv15w>

Laptops

that really hits the ball out of the park in terms of reinforcing your belief in the idea of better-than-average audio off laptops in the coming years.

The main difference between both the HP units lies in their processor and HDD capacity. The HP Pavilion 11-k106TU has the latest 6th gen Intel Core M36Y30, while the Pavilion 11-k107TU has an Intel Pentium N3700 model. And while one comes with 500GB of internal storage, the other packs in a whopping 1TB – not bad at all for an 11-inch form factor ultraportable notebook.

The HP Pavilion 11-k106TU screen brightness and the colour reproduction was better compared to the Pavilion 11-k107TU, which dulled a bit on side by side comparison. So after turning on the laptops the first thing that pops out is the HP Assist registration which is a bit annoying and would come up every time you turn on the laptop screen. We really liked the placement of the Windows button on the Dell machine which was very favourably positioned (at the centre of its bottom screen bezel), but the Windows button in the HP model requires a little getting used to as it is placed on the right side, a very inconvenient position to place the button which takes some getting used.

There is no vents in these laptops, but the heat output from the heat patch is too much in the Pavilion 11-k107TU, making it too difficult to work on while keeping on the lap. But that's about the only gripes we have with both the HP machines.

Also unlike the Dell Inspiron 11, the touchscreen experience was very precise in the tablet mode on both the HP Pavilion 11 notebooks. During sound comparison the Bang & Olufsen speakers really proved to be best in the bunch. Entertainment and other activities went off pretty well on the HP machines, and even their battery life is pretty good. If you have the money to purchase them, we definitely recommend the HP laptops as they're well worth the money – especially the Pavilion 11-k106TU which comes with the latest 6th generation Intel Core M processor. You're definitely getting your money's worth here, especially as both the HP machines also double up as convertible tablets with very good touchscreen feedback.

LENOVO YOGA 300

Out of the box, the Lenovo YOGA hybrid notebook looks pleasing on the eye and feels tightly packed together. Unlike the Dells and the HPs, the YOGA



Lenovo YOGA 300

300 doesn't appear to be a class apart just by looking at it. The two parts of the hybrid laptop are held together by a solid metal hinge, which lets the screen lid and bottom panel rotate up to 360 degrees without feeling anxious or fearful – the build quality exudes a lot of confidence. Even though it's less than 1.5kg in weight, the YOGA 300 feels a touch bulky. It maybe due to the excessively curvy seashell design of the laptop.

As is the case with many Lenovo laptops through the years, the YOGA 300 excels and remains unmatched in terms of input devices. Its curved keys are a joy to type on and the trackpad feels rock solid. Its touch screen is precise in the tablet mode unlike the Dell's. A unique feature among the host of buttons provided on this laptop is the accompaniment of a dedicated key to reset, next to the power and volume rocker which starts the Windows recovery launcher.

The sound quality wasn't as good on the YOGA 300 as compared to some of the HPs and other laptops in this comparison. Even at 50% volume the sound from the speakers got distorted when playing heavy metals. But we encountered a bunch of good pre-loaded software on the Lenovo YOGA 300 – phone

companion, management, etc – which was a thoughtful addition. Unlike the Acer preloaded apps which slowed the processing, this one didn't and actually proved useful, especially with phone companion to access mobile devices easily.

WINNERS

For its overall impressive performance, the Dell Inspiron 11 won the Best Performer Award, and the HP Pavilion 11-k106TU gave it a very good run for its money, finishing up almost equal in terms of score. But the Dell was the fastest overall in terms of CPU performance, had the brightest screen, highest screen readability score, and lowest operating temperature at full load. A deserved winner.

The ASUS EeeBook X205TA is a very good deal at its price, edging out the Acer Aspire E3-112M by winning the price war and the Best Buy Award. It was slightly better than the Acer in terms of performance and build quality and sold for 25% cheaper.

The HP Pavilion 11-k107TU won our Editor's Pick Award, closely edging out the Lenovo YOGA 300 for largely offering better audio performance than the YOGA and doing a generally very good in most departments, performing way better than its Lenovo competitor. **d**



HP Pavilion 11 (k106TU and k107TU)